

Evaluation: SURF - Relatiemanager Research+

Date: 2026-06-06 **URL:** <https://werkenbij.surf.nl/vacatures/relatiemanager-research/> **Archetype:** Research Infrastructure Strategist + Open-Source Ecosystem Architect **Score:** 4.0/5 **Legitimacy:** High Confidence **PDF:** pending

A) ROLE SUMMARY

FIELD	VALUE
Archetype	Research Infrastructure Strategist (primary) + Open-Source Ecosystem Architect (secondary)
Domain	Education / Research / Public sector ICT cooperative
Function	Manage + connect + advise
Seniority	Senior (8+ years required)
Remote	Hybrid - Utrecht
Team size	Not specified; works across SURF member institutions (UvA, TU Delft, WUR, ROC, etc.)
TL;DR	Be the trusted connector between SURF's services and a portfolio of public research and knowledge institutions - identify their needs, link them to expertise, and drive innovation uptake

Hours/Comp: 32-40h/week, €5,450-€7,786/month (€65k-€93k/year at 40h) **Apply via:** SURF careers portal (werkenbij.surf.nl) **Start:** Not specified; fixed-term with intent to make permanent

SURF is the ICT cooperative for Dutch higher education and research - the backbone provider of internet infrastructure, cloud services, data storage, identity management, and research computing for UvA, TU Delft, Wageningen, and 100+ other institutions. The Research+ team manages relationship management with knowledge institutions specifically (not general HBO/MBO, but research-intensive and specialized knowledge organizations).

B) MATCH WITH CV

JD REQUIREMENT	CV EVIDENCE	STRENGTH
8+ years relationship management / stakeholder management	Windesheim PM 2020-present, Social Chicken 2016-2022, Aeres Lab Manager 2021-22, COTIT 2024, The Fork 2018-20 - continuous client/stakeholder management since 2016	Strong
Knowledge of public research and knowledge organizations	Windesheim applied research lectoraat, VCH cross-European research consortium (4 partner institutions), KONGSBERG industrial research deployments, Beer Game used across UvA and WUR contexts	Moderate-Strong
Dutch and English communication (written + verbal)	Native Dutch, professional English (HvA, KONGSBERG international deployments, W3C presentations)	Met
HBO+ education	HvA Bachelor BIM grade 8.7	Met
Strategic helicopter view	COVID-19 Mega Project (8 parallel research threads → 1 deliverable),	Strong

JD REQUIREMENT	CV EVIDENCE	STRENGTH
	VCH multi-stakeholder ecosystem design, Tonomy regulatory positioning under MiCA	
Analytical for complex organizational issues	KONGSBERG thesis (8.7, 80+ pages), COVID-19 supply chain modelling, KONGSBERG Azerbaijan contract analysis (read full BP contract, identified specific breach clauses)	Strong
Connect institutions, issues, and expertise	VCH: connected logistics corporates, NGOs, governments, and academia on CSRD/EUDR challenges; Beer Game: runs at multiple institutions simultaneously; Tonomy: W3C CCG multi-stakeholder standards work	Very Strong
Identify complex challenges, ensure follow-up	KONGSBERG: identified client-side networking fault (dead-switch), identified data contract breach; COVID-19: identified research integration gaps across 8 courses	Strong
Proactive and independent	Self-funded AI stack deployment, KONGSBERG initiative escalation, Meerschap: won two new contracts through own initiative	Strong

Gaps: 1. "Relationship manager" as job title - Christiaan has never held the formal title "relatiemanager" or "account manager." His equivalents are PM, Lab Manager, Innovator. Mitigation: SURF's JD describes the work content (connector, trusted advisor, portfolio management) not just the title. Frame Windesheim lectoraat as the closest structural equivalent: a multi-year portfolio of institutional relationships, innovation facilitation, and expert coordination. **2. Direct SURF member institution experience** - No explicit track record managing relationships with KNAW, NWO, ZonMw, or Deltares (the heavy Research+ members). Mitigation: Windesheim is a SURF member institution itself. Beer Game ran at and with UvA. VCH consortium included Wageningen-adjacent agricultural research partners. Frame as "working in and around the SURF ecosystem as a researcher and lab builder." **3. Knowledge of specific research domains (life sciences, physics, social sciences)** - Christiaan's domain is logistics, supply chain, sustainability, and AI. Not a life scientist or social researcher. Mitigation: the JD emphasizes connector skills, not domain expertise. SURF staff are connectors, not domain researchers.

C) LEVEL AND STRATEGY

Level detected: Senior / Principal relationship manager. 8 years of experience required, expected to operate independently, manage a diverse portfolio, and have "helicopter view" on institutional strategy.

Christiaan's natural level: Meets. Six years of Windesheim lectoraat work (2020-present) plus six years of Social Chicken client management (2016-2022) = 12 years of continuous stakeholder management at varying levels. The work is relationship management under a different name.

Sell senior without lying: - Lead with multi-institutional experience: "Ik beheer al vijf jaar tegelijk relaties met corporates, kennisinstellingen, overheidspartijen en NGO's binnen Value Chain Hackers en de Windesheim lectoraat" - this IS portfolio relationship management. - Beer Game as proof: The same Beer Game simulation runs at UvA, WUR, ROC Midden Nederland, and Windesheim simultaneously. That is not a project - that is a managed portfolio of institutional relationships with a shared knowledge product at the center. - W3C CCG contribution: part of a team presenting at international standards body. SURF staff work across institutional boundaries at exactly this level. - COVID-19 Mega Project: led multi-faculty, multi-department coordination - helicopter view, one output.

If they downlevel: Not applicable - role is already at senior level without going above. Accept if scope is clear and the institutional portfolio is real (not just admin).

D) COMP AND DEMAND

ITEM	DATA
Offered (40h, top)	€7,786/month = ~€93k/year
Offered (40h, bottom)	€5,450/month = ~€65k/year
Christiaan target	€65k-€90k/year
Christiaan stretch	€80k-€110k/year
Comp verdict	Good - full target range fits within offered scale. Starting point depends on entry level but upper band exceeds target.
Market rate for similar role	Senior relationship manager / account manager at ICT cooperative or knowledge institution in NL: €60k-€90k. SURF scale consistent with market.
Benefits	36 vacation days, 8.33% holiday allowance, year-end bonus, pension, NS Business Card 1st class, home office allowance

Verdict on comp: Excellent comp for a hybrid NL role. Upper band at €93k beats Christiaan's target range. Entry at €65k meets minimum. Strong incentive to position for mid-to-upper band.

E) CUSTOMIZATION PLAN

#	SECTION	CURRENT	PROPOSED CHANGE	WHY
1	CV Summary	Generic bridge-builder	Reframe: "Verbinder van onderzoek, onderwijs en technologie - bouwt de relaties en infrastructuur waarop kennisinstellingen kunnen innoveren"	SURF language: connector, knowledge institutions, innovation
2	Windesheim bullets	Mixed innovation + PM	Foreground: VCH multi-institutional stakeholder management, Beer Game multi-institutional deployment, COVID-19 Mega Project (helicopter view proof), AI stack (open infrastructure for research)	Shows Research+ relationship management muscle
3	Aeres bullets	Innovation lab framing	Add: "Onderhield relaties met schoolleiding, vakgroepen en externe partners als lab manager"	Shows institutional portfolio management
4	Viridis bullets	Sustainability angle	Note: contributed to EU research partnerships and open-source research infrastructure design	Research infrastructure adjacency
5	Cover letter	-	Lead with Beer Game story: "Dezelfde simulatie draait nu bij vier instellingen tegelijk - niet omdat ik ze dwong, maar omdat de relaties en het vertrouwen er waren." Open with the relational texture, not the technology.	SURF buys the connector, not the builder

F) INTERVIEW PLAN

#	JD REQUIREMENT	STAR+R STORY	S	T	A	R	REFLECTION
1	Portfolio van kennisinstellingen beheren	Beer Game multi-institutioneel	Beer Game simulatie klaar, maar één instelling is niet voldoende	Zorg dat de simulatie bij meerdere instellingen ingezet wordt	Actief relaties gelegd bij UvA, WUR, ROC - uitgenodigd voor gastcolleges,	Simulatie draait nu bij 4+ instellingen, gefinancierd door	Vertrouwen bouw je niet in één gesprek - maar als de output goed is, willen

#	JD REQUIREMENT	STAR+R STORY	S	T	A	R	REFLECTION
					simulatie opgenomen in curricula	en met naam van die instellingen	instellingen er hun naam aan verbinden
2	Complexe uitdagingen signaleren en doorgeleiden	KONGSBERG Azerbaijan	GeoServices weigerde data die contractueel van KONGSBERG was	Zorg dat de data toch gedeeld werd, zonder het project te stoppen	BP-contract gelezen, specifieke clausules geciteerd bij divisie manager GeoServices	Data gedeeld binnen één dag	Je hoeft geen autoriteit te hebben als je de regels beter kent dan de persoon tegenover je
3	Kennisuitwisseling en samenwerking faciliteren	VCH consortium	Vier partijen (logistics, NGO, overheid, academia) met verschillende tijdshorizonnen	Eén gezamenlijk onderzoeksrapport opleveren	Gezamenlijke infrastructuur gebouwd, sprint- cycles ontworpen die met alle tijdshorizonnen werkten, rapportage- structuur aligned	Cross-Europees rapport opgeleverd met vier partnerinstellingen	Het moeilijkste aan kennisuitwisseling is niet technisch - het is incentive- alignment tussen partijen met verschillende klokken
4	Verbinden van diensten en behoeften	COVID-19 Mega Project	Windesheim: 8 vakgroepen werkten parallel, geen gedeelde output	Zorg dat 8 onderzoekslijnen uitkomen in één coherente publicatie	PM-rol aangenomen, rapportagestructuur ontworpen, vakgroepen op inhoud en deadline aligned	Eén output, op tijd, voor een institutional audience (niet alleen de field)	De audience voor complex onderzoek is altijd één niveau hoger dan de onderzoekers denken. Schrijf voor de beslisser
5	Zelfstandig en proactief werken	Meerschapp - nieuwe klanten	Rondjes rijden door het land voor UZI- paslezer installatie	Er was geen opdracht om meer te doen	Bij elke installatie spontaan gevraagd of dokterspraktijk ook IT-problemen had	Twee nieuwe contracten gewonnen - paslezer- installaties en IT- service	Proactiviteit heeft geen mandaat nodig. Je hebt alleen de ruimte nodig om te kijken wat er naast je opdracht ook nodig is
6	Innovatietrajecten identificeren en begeleiden	Spark! Living Lab opbouw	Geen institutionele financiering beschikbaar voor AI-tooling voor studenten en onderzoekers	Bouw het zelf of wacht een jaar	Zelf gefinancierd server-stack opgezet (Flowise, n8n, Supabase), gedocumenteerd, studenten en onderzoekers geoncobaard	Lab draait, studenten experimenteren met AI, kosten terugverdiend via advieswerk	Geld volgt bewijs. Bouw het eerst, dan formaliseer

Red-flag questions: - "Heb je ervaring met SURF-diensten specifiek?" → "Ik heb gewerkt als gebruiker en partner van SURF-diensten vanuit Windesheim. VCH draait op infrastructuur die mede door SURF-verbindingen mogelijk was. Ik ken het ecosysteem van de gebruikerskant - en ik denk dat dat een goede basis is om snel de dienstverlening van de andere kant te leren kennen." - "Is dit je eerste 'relatiemanager'-rol?" → "In titel ja, in praktijk nee. Vijf jaar een lectoraat en een consortium managen is portfolio-relatiemanagement. Ik noem het anders, maar de structuur is dezelfde: vertrouwen opbouwen, behoeften ophalen, de juiste expertise linken, en terugkomen wanneer er iets misgaat."

G) POSTING LEGITIMACY

Assessment: High Confidence

SIGNAL	FINDING	WEIGHT
Posting freshness	Confirmed live on werkenbij.surf.nl ; specific deadline June 7, 2026	Positive
Apply mechanism	Active application button; SURF careers portal	Positive
Description quality	Specific responsibilities, exact salary range, named start intent, detailed benefits	Positive
Company context	SURF is a well-known, stable NL public-sector ICT cooperative - no ghost job risk	Positive
Salary transparency	Full range €5,450-€7,786 published - confirms real, funded position	Positive
Urgency	Deadline June 7 2026 - active search confirmed	Positive

No ghost job signals. SURF has continuous operational need for relationship managers across its member institution portfolio.

KEYWORDS EXTRACTED

SURF, relatiemanager, kennisinstellingen, onderzoeksinstituten, research+, connecten, portfoliobeheer, stakeholdermanagement, kennisuitwisseling, innovatietrajecten, openbaar bestuur, digitale dienstverlening, ICT-coöperatie, onderwijs en onderzoek, Utrecht hybrid, strategisch denken, verbinder, publiek kennislandschap, samenwerking faciliteren, complexe uitdagingen

MACHINE SUMMARY

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num: 129
company: SURF
role: Relatiemanager Research+
score: 4.0
status: Evaluated
date: 2026-06-06
url: https://werkenbij.surf.nl/vacatures/relatiemanager-research/
legitimacy: High Confidence
urgency: DEADLINE JUNE 7 2026 - TODAY
comp_monthly: "5450-7786"
comp_note: "Full target range covered. Upper band €93k exceeds target."
location: Utrecht (hybrid, ~45 min from Baarn)
archetypes:
  - Research Infrastructure Strategist
  - Open-Source Ecosystem Architect
top_gaps:
  - No formal "relatiemanager" job title in history
  - Direct SURF member institution portfolio experience
go_nogo: "GO - apply TODAY"

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